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logisticians, medical personnel, and reconnaissance, transportation, and aviation units. As depicted in figure 5 on page 12, the number of ongoing partnerships has risen gradually since 2004.

The partnerships were found in eight UN peacekeeping operations deployed in Chad/Central African Republic (MINURCAT), Cyprus (UNFICYP), the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUC/MONUSCO), Haiti (MINUSTAH), Israel/Syria (UNDOF), Lebanon (UNIFIL), Liberia (UNMIL), and Mali (MINUSMA).⁴² Roughly three-quarters (31 of 41, or 76 percent) of all the partnerships occurred in just four missions: UNIFIL (11), UNFICYP (8), MINUSTAH (6), and UNDOF (6). Operational partnerships were established most frequently by European and South American countries, with relatively few examples from the major TCCs from Africa and Asia.

Case Studies: Lebanon and Cyprus Missions

This section analyzes the main motivating factors behind the operational partnerships in UNIFIL in Lebanon and UNFICYP in Cyprus—the two UN missions with the most examples of partnership and the full range of variants identified previously (see table 1). It also examines the implications of these partnerships for the mission and the UN more broadly.

UNIFIL

As of September 2014, UNIFIL was composed of 10,109 peacekeepers from thirty-eight contributing countries, with the largest TCCs being France, Ghana, India, Indonesia, and Italy, each of which contributed more than 800 uniformed personnel. The mission is divided into two sectors: west and east. Sector West comprises five operational battalions led by Finland, Ghana, Indonesia, Italy, and Malaysia. Sector East comprises four operational battalions led by India, Indonesia, Nepal, and Spain. A mobile reserve is composed of a French battalion, and there is a combined maritime task force led by Brazil.

UNIFIL's principal operational activities include

liaison and coordination with and between the parties on the ground, assistance in building the capacities of the Lebanese Armed Forces, and monitoring the cessation of hostilities. Tactical activities include patrolling along the Blue Line,⁴³ area domination patrolling, manning observation posts, conducting foot and vehicle patrols (sometimes in cooperation with the Lebanese Armed Forces), and conducting counter-rocket-launching operations. Since the popular uprising and subsequent outbreak of war in neighboring Syria, UNIFIL has dealt with an influx of refugees and a decrease in the numbers of Lebanese Armed Forces present, due to security responsibilities in other parts of the country, partly from spillover effects of the Syrian conflict.

Since 2004, UNIFIL has housed more operational partnerships than any other UN peacekeeping operation. As of December 2014, it contained seven such partnerships (see table 2). They were established for a variety of reasons. From the UN perspective, bringing more TCCs into a mission expands its contributor base and strengthens the legitimacy of the mission with both local and international audiences. However, from the perspective of TCCs, these partnerships stemmed from a range of alternative motivating factors.

One factor is the desire to become a UN TCC, with UNIFIL as the chosen venue. For example, Brunei deployed its first-ever contingent of UN peacekeepers to UNIFIL in late 2008, and Armenia deployed its first UN contingent to the mission in November 2014.

Another factor motivating partnerships is evident in those UN member states that wish to become a TCC in UNIFIL specifically but require assistance to deploy their preferred type of contingent. Examples include El Salvador, Slovenia, Ireland, and Finland. While El Salvador and Slovenia felt deploying a company was beyond their means and required assistance to deploy even smaller contingents, neither Ireland nor Finland was able to field a battalion alone, but both were able to operate one together. Another example is Serbia, which is a particularly interesting case, because, since 2010, it gradually ramped up its contributions to UNIFIL through a total of eight

42 The number is nine if MONUC and MONUSCO are counted as separate missions.

43 The line of withdrawal established in 2000 to confirm the withdrawal of Israeli forces from Lebanon.

rotation cycles. It began by contributing staff officers, then two sequenced platoons, followed by two sequenced companies.⁴⁴ This suggests that Serbia has used its operational partnerships as a way to boost its independent expeditionary capabilities as well as to assist in the overall modernization of its armed forces. Serbia's ability to increase its deployment to company level is a concrete case of partnerships facilitating the UN's goal of expanding its contributor base. Serbia recently announced its intention to more than double its contributions to UN peacekeeping in the near future.⁴⁵

Some states saw their participation in UNIFIL partnerships as a way to gain operational experience for their armed forces, since there were few chances for international deployment outside of UN missions. Examples included Brunei, Malaysia, and Serbia.

For some countries, their partnership in UNIFIL was also a way to help strengthen broader bilateral political and military relations with the country concerned. This was clearly evident in the cases of Italy-Slovenia, Spain-El Salvador, Finland-Ireland, and Malaysia-Brunei, all of which had prior experience of bilateral military cooperation. For these countries, the opportunity to engage in real operations as opposed to combined training exercises is important in moving the partnership to another level. One variant of this rationale was evident in countries, such as Serbia, seeking to strengthen ties with NATO and EU members in particular. Notably, this worked both ways with Italian representatives suggesting that they were supportive of Serbia's accession to the EU and that its partnership with Serbia within UNIFIL was one way to facilitate political dialogue and demonstrate cooperation.⁴⁶

One operational reason for engaging in partnerships was for a country to free some of its troops from conducting certain tasks. In UNIFIL, conducting force protection for the mission headquarters is a task rotated among the

operational battalions. Italy, however, preferred to allow troops from partner states to assume force protection duties for its battalion. The reason was to permit more Italian troops to be tasked with kinetic operations.⁴⁷ A related operational reason was provided by the officers from the Finnish-Irish (FINIRISH) battalion, who stated that co-deployment and the rotation of battalion command allowed both partners to experience the burdens and responsibilities of commanding a battalion without having to carry the financial costs of deploying the entire battalion themselves.⁴⁸

As noted above, the major implication of these partnerships for the UN is that UNIFIL attracted more TCCs, which is also consistent with the UN's goal of broadening its contributor base, and hence offered the mission's leadership wider political support and leverage from more capitals. It could be seen as generating greater local and international legitimacy as a truly multinational mission.

Politically, UNIFIL provided a significant venue in which, since 2006, some important European powers reengaged with UN peacekeeping after a period of relative absence. Although not the focus of this study, it was also the site of the innovative Strategic Military Cell established in 2006.⁴⁹ UNIFIL has also been a crucible in which political cooperation between partner countries has deepened.

From a more operational perspective, UNIFIL's partnerships have facilitated learning across countries and led to the exchange and refinement of various military best practices, especially for relatively new UN TCCs. Moreover, the partnerships developed in UNIFIL will likely help make multinational operating environments more palatable for newer UN TCCs in future missions. One aspect of this relates to the improved English language skills that contingents develop in theater as they learn to work with new partners and other TCCs.

Although most interviewees were generally positive of UNIFIL's operational partnerships,

44 Interview with Serbian officer in UNIFIL, September 6, 2014.

45 Statement of Serbian Minister of Defense, International Peace Institute "Being a Peacekeeper" roundtable discussion, Belgrade, October 20, 2014.

46 Interview with Italian government official, New York, May 19, 2014.

47 Interview with Italian government official, New York, May 19, 2014.

48 Interview with FINIRISH battalion officers in UNIFIL, September 5, 2014.

49 For an analysis that suggests the Strategic Military Cell had rather minimal impacts, see Ronald Hatto, "UN Command and Control Capabilities: Lessons from UNIFIL's Strategic Military Cell," *International Peacekeeping* 16, No. 2 (2009): 186–98.

some negative perspectives also emerged. These included the view that such partnerships could be problematic in regard to communication (i.e., language as well as technical issues), troop discipline/conduct, and different cultural approaches to some military tasks.⁵⁰ Those raising these views felt that such challenges would be significantly intensified in situations of escalated tension and where peacekeepers were required to carry out more complex kinetic tasks.

Members of the mission also offered some points of caution about the challenges of operational partnerships in less benign environments. One perspective was that the size of such arrangements “should not be considered below battalion level” in war-fighting scenarios.⁵¹ A related view was that operational partnerships “could present some challenges in an escalation of tension situation.”⁵² Retaining independent operational units was considered the least challenging way to conduct operational partnerships, while composite and embedded units were thought to present more challenges.

UNFICYP

As of August 31, 2014, UNFICYP consisted of 854 troops, 58 police, 38 international civil servants, and 112 local civilian staff. Four countries supply the bulk of the troops: the UK has 271; Argentina has 264; Slovakia has 159; and Hungary has 77.⁵³ They are split among three sectors and a multinational headquarters group. The “Argentine contingent” has responsibility for Sector 1. It consists of 264 Argentines, 14 Paraguayans, 13 Chileans, and 1 Brazilian. There are two companies, one in the east and one in the west. The Chileans and Paraguayans command one platoon each in the western company led by an Argentine. Sector 2 is the responsibility of an infantry company made up of approximately 200 British troops. Sector 4 is a multilayered partnering affair among 96 Slovaks, 57 Hungarians, 45 Serbs, 2 Croatians, and 2 Ukrainians. Within the company are partnered a Hungarian platoon (whose 37 Hungarians in turn partner with 6 Serbs), a Serbian platoon (whose 25

Serbs in turn partner with 15 Slovaks), and a Slovak platoon (whose 29 Slovaks in turn partner with 12 Serbs) (see figure 4). This matryoshka effect makes Sector 4 the most intertwined or complex instance of partnering of any UN operation today. Finally the headquarters element includes a fully integrated mobile force reserve (MFR) of 54 Britons (who command the unit), 33 Argentines, 10 Slovaks, and 9 Hungarians. Because of its makeup, the MFR’s briefing proclaimed it to be the “flag-ship for intra UNFICYP cooperation.”

The UNFICYP TCCs offered several reasons why they partnered. Officials from Argentina stressed one factor: the partnering was directed by their country’s political leaders and by the foreign ministry. As a result, Argentina invited Chile and Paraguay to join. They were attractive partners because of the compatibilities in social customs and language. The *Cruz del Sur* initiative between Argentina and Chile furthered reinforced working with Chile (see page 11). Argentine troops are also integrated in the MFR under British command, which is notable given the hostile relationship between these two states a couple of decades earlier.⁵⁴

A second rationale was that partnerships led to a sharing of exposure to the political risks that can arise in peacekeeping missions such as UNFICYP where local parties can agitate and push their way into the buffer zone. Partnering could also plug gaps among the senior partner’s forces by integrating enabling capacities, including logistics and engineering.

Three intertwined rationales behind partnerships include the benefits for a country in improving its military by working with and learning from others; promoting regional cohesion by combining specifically with neighbors; and demonstrating to (potential) alliance members that it is or can be a worthy member of the alliance. This was especially the case with Eastern European countries that had been at odds with one another in the 1990s. Partnering together now in UN missions outside their neighborhood advanced those ends, including

50 Briefing from UNIFIL headquarters, September 4, 2014, and interviews with UNIFIL personnel, September 6, 2014.

51 Briefing from UNIFIL headquarters, September 4, 2014.

52 Briefing from UNIFIL headquarters, September 4, 2014.

53 UN DPKO statistics, available at www.un.org/en/peacekeeping/resources/statistics/contributors_archive.shtml.

54 Argentine and British peacekeepers operated alongside one another in the Balkans operations in the 1990s.

the aim of serving in NATO missions. The Eastern Europeans emphasized their national efforts to adhere to NATO standards (including English language proficiency) and their preference, should it come to it, for participating in NATO missions over UN missions. Thus, while the UN comes across as the less attractive partner, it still has benefits at least in the short term.

Like UNIFIL, challenges were identified, including the sentiment that a single national unit was more effective than a partnered unit since the partners might differ in language, social customs, tactics, techniques, procedures, work ethic, enforcement of discipline, rules of engagement, and the like. In short, depending on circumstances, one needs to weigh the benefits of partnering with the implications for mission effectiveness. It was broadly accepted, however, that more benign missions were more forgiving when incompatibility problems inevitably surfaced. Nevertheless, with more careful preparations by partners to work together, the rough edges of incompatibilities can be smoothed down—but perhaps never eliminated altogether.

Motives for Operational Partnerships

Why do states participate in operational partnerships in UN peacekeeping operations? The short answer is that it facilitates deployment. Some states might be unable to participate on their own: the practical burdens of meeting personnel numbers,

equipment requirements, standards of performance, lift, and the like are too great. Thus, if they are to participate, then they are driven to collaborate with TCCs willing to assist them. More practically, capable contributors may still want to share the (political and operational) burdens and thus are driven to take on the role of senior partners. Equal partners share or trade off command and operational burdens. A senior partner is unique in that it shares a junior partner's practical burdens that would otherwise prevent its deployment. In other words, partners need not have the same motives. It is the synergy that counts.

Since 2004, approximately 120 countries per year were motivated to be UN TCCs, with more than forty participating in operational partnerships. Twenty-one of the fifty-seven governments surveyed by the authors expressed a willingness to do so in the future. Their specific reasons are concrete and more textured variations of the core motives driving peacekeepers in general.

POLITICAL AND FOREIGN POLICY MOTIVES

Some reasons for partnering may stem from a TCC's foreign policies (see table 3). One is enhancing a region's cohesion and clout. Both Argentine and Chilean officials noted that their partnering with other Latin American states resulted from national leadership directives to make their region more of a recognized player on the international scene and, in the course of accomplishing this, to make the region more self-sufficient and independent of the United States and

Table 3. Largely foreign policy motives for partnering

Motive	Applicability
1. Enhance the cohesion and clout of the TCCs' regions	
2. Cement relations with neighbors, affiliates, security guarantors, and rising powers	
3. Though possessing a modest military, be recognized as a responsible and militarily active international citizen	Junior partners
4. Present a new and more attractive international profile to neighbors and beyond	
5. Prove one's worthiness to be a security and/or economic partner	
6. Enhance legitimacy and international or domestic support for a mission that engages one's interests	Senior partners